

While we may never know the answer for sure, my personal hunch is that the court jester makes frequent visits to the royal library and reads *Reminiscences of a Stock Operator* by Edwin Lefèvre, *The Crowd* by Gustav LeBon, *Extraordinary Popular Delusions and the Madness of Crowds* by Charles Mackay, and the entire *Market Wizards* series by Jack Schwager.

Trading, it turns out, is the solution to most economic problems; *free markets*, *sanctity of trading*, and *healthy economy* are all ways to say the same thing. In this sense, our traders are champions and the men and women in Jack Schwager's books are our heroes.

Schwager's books define trading by vividly portraying traders. He finds the best examples, he makes them human and accessible, and he allows them to express, in their own ways, what they do and how they do it. He gives us a gut feel for the struggles, challenges, joys, and sorrows all of them face over their entire careers. We wind up knowing each of his subjects intimately—and also as a uniquely complete expression of repeating themes, such as: be humble; go with the flow; manage risk; do it your own way.

Schwager's books are essential reading for anyone who trades, wants to trade, or wants to pick a trader.

I go back a ways with Jack. I recall meeting him while we were both starting out as traders, long on enthusiasm and short on experience. Over the years, I watched him grow, mature, and develop his talent, evolving to become our Chronicler-General.

Schwager's contribution to the industry is enormous. His original *Market Wizards* inspired a whole new generation of traders, many of whom subsequently appeared in *The New Market Wizards*, and then, in turn, in *Stock Market Wizards*. Jack's *Wizards* series becomes the torch that traders pass from one generation to the next. Now *Hedge Fund Market Wizards* extends, enhances, and perfects the tradition. Traders regularly use passages and chapters from Schwager's books as a reference for their own methods and to guide their own trading. His work is an inseparable part of the consciousness and language of trading itself.

Some 30 years ago, Jack reads *Reminiscences of a Stock Operator* and notices its meaningfulness and relevance, even 60 years after its